

Paper 1: Listening, reading and translation

Content

Students will be assessed on their understanding of spoken and written French from a variety of types of authentic texts and listening material, as well as their ability to translate accurately from French into English.

Texts and recordings vary in length to include some extended passages. All spoken and written materials are culturally relevant to France and French-speaking countries and are drawn from the four themes (listed on *pages 8–9*).

Students should be able to:

- understand main points, gist and detail from spoken and written material
- infer meaning from complex spoken and written material
- assimilate and use information from spoken and written sources, including material from online media
- summarise information from spoken sources, reporting key points and subject matter
- translate from French into English.

Listening

The listening section will be made up of spoken passages covering different registers and types, including authentic communication involving one or more male and female speakers. Sources will include material from online media.

Reading

The reading section will be made up of texts containing both factual and abstract content and will be authentic or adapted from authentic sources. The texts will include contemporary, historical, literary, fiction and non-fiction, written for different purposes and audiences.

Translation into English

The content of the translation will be taken from one of the four themes.

Assessment information

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The total assessment time is 2 hours. Recommended timings for each section are given below.
- The assessment is out of 80 marks.
- There are three sections in the paper, they cover the assessment of listening, reading and translation skills in French.
- Students must answer all questions in each section (A, B and C).
- The use of dictionaries is not permitted.

- For Section A (listening), 50 minutes (recommended timing), 30 marks:
 - there are four questions in this section made up of multiple choice and open response, including questions testing summary skills; all questions are set in French and must be answered in French
 - students will listen to a recording featuring French-language speakers who will speak at a speed appropriate for the expected understanding at this level
 - recordings will be issued as audio files via our Secure Download Service (SDS) prior to the exam
 - students will have individual control of the recording and may stop, revisit and replay sections of the recording as they wish.
- For Section B (reading), 50 minutes (recommended), 30 marks:
 - students respond to five questions based on the texts provided
 - questions comprise both multiple-choice questions and open-response questions; all questions are set in French and must be answered in French.
- For Section C (translation into English), 20 minutes (recommended), 20 marks:
 - students are given one unseen text in French and must translate it into English.

The recommended timings have been set to enable the student to complete each section in sufficient time.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme for this paper can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 3 Advanced GCE in French Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.

The listening audio files are available on our website.